

Manual

OPC Server for Modbus Communication OPC-SMB 8.1

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1 Overview OPC Server for Modbus Communication

Overview

In the world of automation the OPC standard has spread more and more and is still advancing to establish a direct communication with machines. For further information on OPC (OLE for Process Control), please refer to the respective documentation or the website of the OPC foundation <http://www.opcfoundation.org>.

Purpose

To connect machines with the HYDRA system, HYDRA provides an OPC server.

This OPC server reads out the data fields of the machine and provides the OPC client with it.

This approach can be used for data from the following HYDRA modules:

- MDE - Machine Data Collection (counters/meters, cycle, status)
- PDV - Process Data Collection (process values)
- DNC - Direct Numerical Control (setting values)
- Scale values

Implementation notes

In general, communication is based on the exchange of data using defined variables in the OPC server. The variable contents of machines are provided as labeled data points/OPC items in the OPC server. The OPC client connects application programs with these variables. Thus, read and write accesses to OPC items are made available for application programs in a specific and transparent way. The OPC-DA specification in version 2.0 defines the data transport. For further details on which data points can be provided by a specific control, please refer to the corresponding documentation about the control in question.

Integration

The OPC server is installed on a data acquisition PC and/or terminal (Windows). It is used, for example, to connect machines via CT-UMPS.

Functions

Configurable OPC server to communicate with machines and controls transferring OPC variables, e.g. machine statuses, process data and meter readings.

Installation and configuration

The document entitled "CT-UMPS installation" provides further information on the installation and configuration.